In the workshop with... Juergen Heid

We go into the workshop with German woodturner **Juergen Heid**

In 1984 Juergen started an apprenticeship as a cabinetmaker, but this finished after three years and unfortunately, he decided to stop woodworking. Luckily, Juergen's best friend convinced him to become a master of cabinetmaking and so he trained for a further two and a half years. Having finished training, Juergen wasn't yet 24 years old, so he wasn't able to train people himself.

Following this, Juergen worked in a kitchen store for 10 years, designing and planning kitchens. Over the years at the kitchen store, woodturning took a backseat. Juergen soon bought his own shop, but this closed seven years later. It was at this point that he remembered his love for woodworking. Juergen then went on to work for two years in joinery, then moving on to training young handicapped people, with autism, physical and learning disabilities.

PHOTOGRAPHS BY JUERGEN HEID UNLESS OTHERWISE STATED

Tell us about your background

While in my apprenticeship I bought my first lathe. I start woodturning, trying different things to build. After my time at the kitchen store my passion woke up again, but I didn't have the lathe anymore.

I decided to buy a cheap lathe, because I wanted to do only a little woodturning. I soon saw it wasn't the right lathe for me and decided to invest in one from Killinger. A Killinger 1400 SE is everything I need! It was the best investment I ever made. I saw pens made from wood and I thought this is what I want to create. I went to a further education course by Hans Schulte Drechselshop with Horst Pieper for one day. This was enough for me to go my own way

How did you get into woodturning?

In school I saw a round piece of wood, bigger at the ends than in the middle and in the middle there was a ring. I wondered how can this can be made and I decided to try it out

Describe your turning style and the types of work you produce

Most pen makers want to show the unbelievable shapes they can create. For me this is ugly. At home I go in my workshop to try out what

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